

“From cash flow statements to profit and loss and balance sheets, GNUKhata can do it all,” says KK. This software helps you keep track of your inventory. You can create invoices, cash memos, delivery challans, purchase orders, rejection notes, debit and credit notes. And it’s the same for your bank reconciliation also.

KK explains: “We have a feature called Close Books. You actually close your books at the end of the financial year. All your profit and expense accounts are debited or credited to ‘Profit and Loss’. You get the ‘Profit and Loss’ balanced properly. The books are closed, and the accounts are locked. You also have an option called ‘Roll Over’, by which all the closing balances are carried over as opening balances to the next year. You can roll over without closing the books – to wait for your audits to be completed till you close your books.”

GNUKhata also has a very interesting feature called ‘Dual-level’. Using this, you can open two ledgers side by side on the screen, and you can compare them. These could be of the same account but for different periods, or different accounts for different periods, or different accounts for the same period. This is a feature that GNUKhata users really seem to appreciate.

GNUKhata also allows users to read down from trial balance to ledger, and ledger to voucher. “Right now, the application is India focused. It was pretty focused on the international market earlier, but we worked so much on ensuring it is GST compliant, that we have to now work to get it internationally compliant as well,” says KK. For instance, one user in Nepal said that he liked the product, but the GST modules didn’t make any sense there. KK also concedes that work is needed to fix multiple currencies and other factors that will allow the software to get adopted worldwide.

The flip side is that it works nicely for those wanting GST support.

After being made GST-compliant, all documents including invoices and delivery notes are now created as per GST regulations. “Importantly, GNUKhata can import data from the widely used proprietary Tally-like software through exported spreadsheets from proprietary programs,” says KK. In reply to a query on how GNUKhata compares with GnuCash, he says, “You cannot compare them. GnuCash is basically a personal accounting system. You can use GNUKhata like GnuCash. But then, it’s like using a crane to lift a small brick.”

GnuCash is a personal, financial accounting software used by SMEs, licensed under the GNU/GPL and available for Linux, Windows, Mac OS X, BSD and Solaris. The project was begun in 1997 and written primarily in C, with a small fraction in Scheme, the programming language that follows a minimalist design philosophy.

“Maybe you could ask how GNUKhata ranks compared to Tally or QuickBooks. In which case, I would say, it compares favourably. Except for a few very complex reports, some of which QuickBooks has, and a couple of which Tally has (and these are not used by everyone, by the way)...barring those, I don’t think there’s any other issue that people have pointed out,” says KK.

And for retailers, the software can manage the point of sale. “GNUKhata is nothing but APIs,” KK explains.

Stock reports can be seen at the ‘godown level’. So if you have multiple godowns, you can check what the stock level in each of them is.

KK says he is always glad to interact with software professionals and those in the accounting space too. He jokes, “I now have enough knowledge to do at least a B.Com (in accounting).”

He credits Arun Kelkar, a chartered accountant with three-and-a-half-decades of experience, as being the chief domain expert.

GNUKhata, which is based on double-entry bookkeeping, comes in two forms—the Web based application which can run through a browser and a

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